

# Principles of Microeconomics

## ECON 1101

### Course Info



T & R



(Sec A) 1:15 - 2:40 pm



Visual Arts Center - 304 N



(Sec B) 10:05 - 11:30 am



Roux - 207

### Instructor Info



**Seeun Park**

(pronounced SEH-n; she/her)



Student Hrs:

M & W 1 - 3 pm,

T & R 3 - 4:30 pm,

“or” by appointment



Hubbard Hall - 113



s.park@bowdoin.edu

### Learning Assistants



**Athalia Esty**

(she/her)



Student Hrs:

Sun 7:30 - 9 pm



Hubbard Hall - 213



aesty@bowdoin.edu



**Cadence Lee**

(she/her)



Student Hrs:

Sun 7:00 - 8:30 pm



Mills - 103



clee2@bowdoin.edu

## 1 Overview

Economics is the study of how individuals, businesses, and governments make choices about allocating limited resources to achieve their goals. In this course, we focus on the behavior and decision-making of economic agents, such as consumers and firms, using theories of demand, supply, cost, and market structures. You will apply economic principles covered in the class to real-world problems, which will help you develop a deeper understanding of the world.

## 2 Learning Objectives

By the end of the course, you should be able to:

1. **Identify** introductory microeconomic topics and concepts related to supply and demand, producer and consumer choice, and how the market works in today's society.
2. **Describe** economic concepts in your own words using relevant real-world examples
3. **Use graphs and basic math/formulas to explain** the discussed economic ideas
4. **Analyze** and **evaluate** real-world situations using course concepts
5. **Create** original explanations of discussed economic concepts using real-world examples and creative formats

## 3 Course Materials and Devices

- **Interactive Notes:** Interactive Notes are templates with key concepts, examples, and exercises to help you engage with the material. Download them from Canvas to use on a tablet or print them out.
- **Textbook:** The textbook is *Principles of Microeconomics* (3rd ed.) by OpenStax. A PDF is available on Canvas.
  - If you prefer a more polished physical textbook, you may also check out *Principles of Microeconomics* by Mateer and Coppock (supplementary, not required).
- **Other Materials:** Other additional required or optional readings and media materials will be available on Canvas.
- **Canvas:** Canvas will be the course hub for announcements, materials, assignments, feedback, and other resources. Check it regularly and turn on notifications to stay updated.
- **Gradescope:** You will submit your Problem Sets on Gradescope. A link to submit your work on Gradescope will be posted on Canvas.
- **Poll Everywhere:** Poll Everywhere will be used for real-time engagement and feedback during lectures. Registration instructions are on Canvas.

## 4 Grading Scheme

Here's how your grade will be determined, with each assessment weighted as follows:

|     |                                                   |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------|
| 10% | <b>Participation</b>                              |
| 28% | <b>Problem Sets</b> (7 sets, 4% each)             |
| 50% | <b>Exams</b> (Exam 3: 20%, Exams 1 & 2: 15% each) |
| 12% | <b>Project</b>                                    |

Final course grades are based on the weighted average of all components. There is no fixed curve that limits how many students can earn each grade. While not guaranteed, students with averages in the 60s may be considered for a passing grade (C range) at the instructor's discretion.

Grades will follow the standard scale: A =  $\geq 90$ ; B = 80-89.99; C = 70-79.99; D = 60-69.99; F < 60.

### 4.1 Participation: Group Activity

To encourage active and cooperative learning, you will often work in groups during class. Full credit (10%) is earned by participating in 10 or more modules; if you participate in fewer, your score will equal the number of modules completed (e.g., 5 modules = 5%).

Groups will be assigned and will change twice during the semester:

- *Group 1*: Start of semester to Exam 1
- *Group 2*: After Exam 1 to Exam 2
- *Group 3*: After Exam 2 to end of semester

Absent members will not earn credit for that module.

### 4.2 Problem Sets

Problem sets (PS) provide an excellent opportunity to apply economic concepts to analyze and evaluate real-world problems using graphs, equations, and models. While most questions will focus on the current week's material, some may also review concepts from previous weeks.

- Problem sets will be posted on **Tuesdays after 3 PM** and are **due the following Tuesday at 9 AM**, except PS 6 (see Class Schedule).
- **Late work** will be accepted for up to one week after the original deadline with a 20% deduction. After the answer keys are posted (9 AM on the Tuesday following the original deadline), no late submissions will be accepted.
- Out of a total of 9 problem sets, the lowest 2 will be dropped.
- You can work in groups, but must submit your own work (see Group Work).
- Problem Sets **must be submitted on Gradescope**, not Canvas.
- Using generative AI, such as ChatGPT, is not permitted (see Academic Integrity).

### 4.3 Exams

There will be three exams in this course:

| Exam         | Date                    | Time                        | Material Covered                        |
|--------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Exam 1 (15%) | Tue, Sep 30             | During Class Time           | Modules 1–4                             |
| Exam 2 (15%) | Thu, Oct 23             | During Class Time           | Modules 5–8                             |
| Exam 3 (20%) | Sun, Dec 21 (Section A) | 1:30 – 4:30 PM<br>VAC 304 N | Cumulative:                             |
|              | Thu, Dec 18 (Section B) | 8:30 – 11:30 AM<br>Roux 207 | 80% Modules 9–14<br>20% Earlier Modules |

**Please note that the times for Exam 1 and Exam 2** have changed from evening to **in-class**. Each Exams will focus on the modules listed above, but key concepts from earlier course material may also appear. Additional details about exam format and policies will be announced before each exam.

### 4.4 Project: “ECON-IN-THE-WILD”

Throughout the semester, I will share real-world examples with you. For this individual project, you’ll find your own example from the world (“wild”) and share it with your classmates. We’ll also play an in-class game based on your work. For more details, please refer to the separate project document.

| Version | Deadline*   | Notes                                                           |
|---------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Draft** | Tue, Nov 11 | Submit to receive feedback (optional).                          |
| First   | Tue, Nov 18 | <b>Must be on time</b> (20% late penalty, 9-hour grace period). |
|         | Thu, Nov 20 | In-class Activity                                               |
| Final   | Tue, Dec 16 | Optional revision; if not submitted, first version is final.    |

\* All deadlines are 11:59 PM ET.

\*\* *Whenever you’re ready, feel free to discuss your ideas with the instructor, even before November 11.*

## 5 Attendance

Class is most rewarding when we learn together. Being here makes discussions richer, activities more engaging, and the whole experience more enjoyable. I don’t formally take attendance, but participation depends on being present.

## 6 Group Work

Feel free to work on problem sets with others, but **turn in your own work**. Don’t forget to **note the names of your group members** on your submission. Here’s an effective approach:

- First, review the notes and read the textbook if needed.
- Second, solve all practice questions on your own.
- Third, meet with your group to discuss the problem set.
- Fourth, write your own answers after the discussion and submit them.

## 7 Late Work Policy

### 7.1 Make-up Exams

Make-up exams will only be allowed with **prior approval** (for scheduled conflicts such as religious observance or university-approved activities) or in cases of **documented emergencies** (such as illness, accident, or family emergency). Documentation must be provided as soon as possible.

Make-up exams will cover the same material but **may differ in format or include slightly modified questions or numbers**. This ensures fairness while helping maintain academic integrity. Students are expected to take the make-up exam as soon as possible following the missed exam.

### 7.2 Late Problem Sets Submission

Since the lowest two problem sets (PS) are dropped, no make-ups are allowed. You may either skip a week (no explanation needed) or submit late with a penalty (see Grading Scheme). Any work submitted after the answer key is posted or without prior notification will receive a zero.

Q: I have already missed two (2) PS but now have to miss another due to an emergency.

A: You may submit late without penalty for acceptable reasons (e.g., documented sports events, illness, or family emergencies) if you notify me before the original deadline.

### 7.3 Late Project Submission

Because the project is tied to in-class activities, the first version is due on **November 18**. A 9-hour grace period is allowed. Submissions after that lose 20% if turned in before class on November 20, and 50% if later. (See Project Deadlines)

## 8 Academic Integrity

Academic integrity means doing your own work honestly and giving proper credit when you use others' ideas. You can read more about Bowdoin's Academic Honor Code and related policies on Canvas.

### 8.1 Uses of Generative AI

Generative AI can be useful, but relying on it means skipping valuable learning. **Do not use AI to solve Problem Sets**. Think of them like practice exams: *if you would not be able to use the internet or AI on exam day, do not use it here either.*

**For your Project, avoid AI during the analysis stage.** Limited use is acceptable for tasks such as:

- Grammar or style checks
- Citation formatting help

If you are unsure whether a use is appropriate, ask me first.

## 9 Tips for Success in this Class

1. **Attend class:** Annotated notes will be posted, but being present makes the material clearer and easier.
2. **Ask questions:** whether in class, during Student Hours, or by email.
3. **Stay engaged:** Active participation reinforces learning.
4. **Check Canvas regularly:** Stay up to date and avoid missing important announcements or materials.
5. **Review notes daily:** Revisiting notes each day helps solidify your understanding.
6. **Understand the material before practicing:** Practice is most effective once the concepts are clear.
7. **Work on problem sets independently:** Try them on your own first, then discuss with others or ask me or the LAs for help. On exams, you'll be on your own.
8. **Talk to me about concerns:** If something is unclear, reach out — I'm here to help.

## 10 Communication

### 10.1 Canvas

Course announcements will be posted on **Canvas**. Please turn on notifications (*do this now!*).

### 10.2 Student Hours

**The best way to get support is during Student Hours**, which are dedicated to helping you with this course. I strongly encourage you to stop by my office (one of the best offices in Hubbard!). If Student Hours don't fit your schedule, email me to set up an appointment.

### 10.3 Email

I aim to respond within 24 hours, though messages sent after 6 PM may be answered the next day. **When emailing me**, include [Econ 1101 A(B)] in the subject line (e.g., [Econ 1101A] Extra Student Hour).

## 11 Student Support Resources

### 11.1 Accommodations

You may need accommodations for different reasons, such as a documented disability or observing a major religious holiday.

- **Disability accommodations:**
  - Register with the **Student Accessibility Office**.
  - Once approved, please meet with me within the first 2 weeks of class (or as soon as you become aware of your needs) to ensure they are implemented.
- **Religious observances:** You may make up coursework missed due to observing a major religious holiday, provided you make arrangements with me in advance and notify me within the first 2 weeks of class.

### 11.2 Academic, Personal, and College Support

Bowdoin provides many resources to support your success, well-being, and sense of belonging in this course and beyond.

- **Baldwin Center for Learning and Teaching (BCLT):** Peer tutoring, writing help, Q-Tutors for Math/Science/Stats/Econ, and academic mentoring.
- **Counseling Services:** Confidential mental health support and resources.
- **College Policies:** Bowdoin is committed to diversity, inclusion, and a safe learning environment. This includes policies related to Title IX and mandated reporting. Full details and resources are available on Canvas.

## 12 Class Schedule

| Week                              | Date   | Topic                                                                   | PS (Posted)* | PS (Due)* | Chapter                     |
|-----------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------|-----------------------------|
| <b>1: How Markets Work</b>        |        |                                                                         |              |           |                             |
| 1                                 | Sep 2  | Introduction: Course Overview &<br>Module 1: Thinking Like an Economist |              |           | 1.1-1.3                     |
|                                   | Sep 4  | Module 2: Gains from Trade                                              |              |           | 2.2                         |
| 2                                 | Sep 9  | Module 2 (cont.)                                                        | PS 1         |           | 19.1-19.2                   |
|                                   | Sep 11 | Module 2 (cont.)                                                        |              |           |                             |
| 3                                 | Sep 16 | Module 3: Demand and Supply                                             | PS 2         | ★PS 1     | 3.1-3.3                     |
|                                   | Sep 18 | Module 3 (cont.)                                                        |              |           |                             |
| 4                                 | Sep 23 | Module 4: Elasticity                                                    | PS 3         | ★PS 2     | 5.1-<br>5.2,5.4             |
|                                   | Sep 25 | Module 4 (cont.)                                                        |              |           |                             |
| 5                                 | Sep 30 | <b>Exam 1</b>                                                           |              | ★PS 3     |                             |
|                                   | Oct 2  | Module 5: Market Outcome & Tax Incidence                                |              |           | 3.5                         |
| <b>2: When Markets Don't Work</b> |        |                                                                         |              |           |                             |
| 6                                 | Oct 7  | Module 5 (cont.)                                                        | In-class     | ★PS 4     | 5.3                         |
|                                   | Oct 9  | Module 6: Price Controls                                                | PS 5         |           | 3.4                         |
| 7                                 | Oct 14 | <i>Fall vacation</i>                                                    |              |           |                             |
|                                   | Oct 16 | Module 7: Externalities                                                 |              |           | 12.1-<br>12.3,<br>13.1-13.3 |
| 8                                 | Oct 21 | <u>Review</u>                                                           |              | ★PS 5     |                             |
|                                   | Oct 23 | <b>Exam 2</b>                                                           |              |           |                             |

\* **Problem Sets (PS)** will be posted by 3 PM and are due by 9 AM on the specified dates.

| Week                                     | Date   | Topic                                    | PS (Posted)* | PS (Due)*               | Chapter   |
|------------------------------------------|--------|------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------|-----------|
| <b>3: How Consumers and Firms Behave</b> |        |                                          |              |                         |           |
| 9                                        | Oct 28 | Module 8 Consumer Choice                 | PS 6         |                         | 6.1-6.2   |
|                                          | Oct 30 | Module 9 Business Costs and Production   |              |                         | 7.1-7.5   |
| 10                                       | Nov 4  | Module 10: Firms in a Competitive Market | PS 7         | ★PS 6                   | 8.1-8.4   |
|                                          | Nov 6  | Module 10 (cont.)                        |              |                         |           |
| 11                                       | Nov 11 | Module 11: Monopoly                      | PS 8         | ★PS 7                   | 9.1-9.2   |
|                                          | Nov 13 | Module 11 (cont.)                        |              |                         |           |
| 12                                       | Nov 18 | Module 12: Monopolistic Competition      |              | ★PS 8<br>Project V1     | 10.1      |
|                                          | Nov 20 | “ECON-IN-THE-WILD”                       |              |                         |           |
| 13                                       | Nov 25 | <i>Thanksgiving</i>                      |              |                         |           |
|                                          | Nov 27 | <i>Thanksgiving</i>                      |              |                         |           |
| 14                                       | Dec 2  | Module 13: Oligopoly                     | PS 9         |                         | 10.2      |
|                                          | Dec 4  | Module 13 (cont.)                        |              |                         |           |
| 15                                       | Dec 9  | Module 14: Asymmetric Information        |              | ★PS 9                   | 16.1-16.2 |
|                                          | Dec 11 | <u>Review</u>                            |              |                         |           |
| 16                                       | Dec 16 | <i>Reading Period (Dec 13-16)</i>        |              | Project V2 <sup>‡</sup> |           |
|                                          | Dec 18 | <b>Exam 3 (Section B)</b>                |              |                         |           |
|                                          | Dec 21 | <b>Exam 3 (Section A)</b>                |              |                         |           |

\* **Problem Sets (PS)** are due by 9 AM on the specified dates.

† The **first version** of the project (**Project V1**) is due Tuesday, Nov 18 at 11:59 PM.

‡ The **final version** of the project (**Project V2**) is due Tuesday, Dec 16 at 11:59 PM



## 13 Important Dates

| Date        | Event                                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Tue, Sep 16 | <i>Add/Drop ends at 5:00pm</i>                            |
| Tue, Sep 30 | <b>Exam 1</b> (in-class)                                  |
| Tue, Oct 21 | <i>Extended Course Drop ends</i>                          |
| Thu, Oct 23 | <b>Exam 2</b> (in-class)                                  |
| Tue, Nov 18 | <b>Project V1</b> due (11:59 PM)                          |
| Tue, Dec 16 | <b>Project V2</b> due (11:59 PM)                          |
| Thu, Dec 18 | <b>Exam 3:</b> Section B (8:30 – 11:30 AM, Roux 207)      |
| Sun, Dec 21 | <b>Exam 3:</b> Section A (1:30 – 4:30 PM, VAC 304 N)      |
| Sun, Dec 21 | Last day to initiate the <i>Incomplete</i> for the course |

Section A 1:15 PM class

Section B 10:05 AM class